

BorgBackup Emergency Restore Cheat Sheet

Emergency restore flow: **STOP** → **LIST** → **MOUNT** → **RESTORE** → **UNMOUNT** → **START**

Phase 1: Stop All Activity

```
# Stop all running Docker containers
sudo docker stop $(sudo docker ps -q)
```

Note: Never overwrite database files while Docker containers are running. Shut them down first.

Phase 2: Find Your Target Backup

```
# List all available backups
sudo borg list /mnt/sdcard_storage/borg_db_archive
```

Note: Note the exact archive name, for example: db-backup-2026-09-29_11:57

Phase 3: Open the Time Machine (Mounting)

```
# 1. Create a temporary folder
sudo mkdir -p /mnt/restore_temp

# 2. Mount the specific archive (replace archive name with your target)
sudo borg mount /mnt/sdcard_storage/borg_db_archive::db-backup-2026-09-29_11:57 /mnt/restore_temp
```

Note: Inside /mnt/restore_temp, Borg preserves the original folder paths. You should see mnt, then 120gb_ssd, etc.

Phase 4: Restore the Files

```
# External bind-mounted databases
sudo rsync -aAXv --delete /mnt/restore_temp/mnt/120gb_ssd/Container_Databases/ /mnt/120gb_ssd/Container_Databases/

# Docker internal volumes
sudo rsync -aAXv --delete /mnt/restore_temp/mnt/120gb_ssd/docker_data/volumes/ /mnt/120gb_ssd/docker_data/volumes/
```

Note: IMPORTANT: --delete removes files that exist in the live destination but not in the selected backup, helping replace corrupted/newer files with the backup version.

Phase 5: Clean Up & Eject

```
# Unmount the archive
sudo borg umount /mnt/restore_temp

# Delete the temporary folder
sudo rm -rf /mnt/restore_temp
```

Note: Unmount the Borg archive before removing or reusing the SD card.

Phase 6: Bring the Server Back Online

```
# Start all Docker containers
sudo docker start $(sudo docker ps -a -q)
```

Note: Containers will boot using the restored files.

Emergency Fallback: Immich PostgreSQL ONLY

```
# 1. Start the database container
sudo docker start immich_postgres

# 2. Inject the SQL dump directly into PostgreSQL
cat /mnt/120gb_ssd/Container_Databases/immich_db_dump/immich_latest.sql | sudo docker exec -i immich_postgres psql -U post
```

Note: Use this only if restoring the raw Immich database folder does not resolve the Immich database corruption.

Emergency order: STOP Docker → LIST archive → MOUNT → RESTORE → UNMOUNT → START Docker → use Immich SQL fallback only if necessary.